

Attachment 5

Participant Information Sheet

To Renounce Liberty? A Public-Goods Experiment on (Un)Democratic Reversal

Janne Tukiainen | janne.tukiainen@utu.fi | Version 2.0 | 31 August 2026

Invitation and purpose

You are invited to participate in a study of how people make group decisions about public-service provision when conditions change. The target is 300 adults who complete the study through the University of Turku PCRC Decision Laboratory. You are eligible if you are at least 18 years old and can attend the scheduled laboratory session.

The study is led by Janne Tukiainen, Professor at the Turku School of Economics, University of Turku. It is designed to improve scientific understanding of group decision making. It does not assess your intelligence, political identity, or moral character.

Voluntary participation

Joining TOKA means that you have accepted PCRC's general laboratory rules and TOKA privacy notice. Participation in this particular study remains voluntary. Before any experimental decision, the interface gives concise study-specific information and asks you to confirm that you agree to take part. You may decline before the interactive task or stop during the session without giving a reason and without consequences for your studies, employment, or access to University services. If you wish to stop, notify the laboratory manager so that the interacting group can be managed safely. Information already collected may continue to be used for scientific research in the public interest as described in the separate privacy notice. PCRC can connect your identity to your participant code only until payment is complete. PCRC then deletes the link, after which the research team cannot locate your individual coded record.

What participation involves

You will attend one session at the PCRC Decision Laboratory lasting approximately 60 minutes. Data collection is planned for 1–31 October 2026. After the study-specific participation confirmation and unpaid practice, you will complete twenty paid rounds in two blocks of ten. You remain in the same anonymous matching pool of 10 or 15 participants, but the software reshuffles that pool into two or three groups of five before every round.

The final participating roster must be divisible into groups of five. Ten-person pools are formed whenever possible; one fifteen-person pool may be used when needed. If more people arrive on time than can enter a valid roster, PCRC applies its usual arrival-order and compensation procedures before paid play. Once paid play begins, nobody enters or changes matching pools.

Each round begins with 20 experimental points. The five participants choose between two methods for a public-services fund:

- **Group approval required.** The software selects one participant to propose the same fund allocation for everyone and any personal transfer. The other four see the full proposal; at least three must approve. A two–two split rejects it, after which everyone chooses their own allocation.
- **Decision takes effect directly.** The software selects a participant in the same way and the same proposal is possible, but it takes effect without an approval vote by the other four participants.

The method receiving at least three of the five method ballots is used. The selected person is chosen afterward from those who have served least often; ties are random. Your ballot is not shown to other participants. Everyone sees group totals and their own payoff after the round.

The two possible Block-2 updates

All participants begin in a fictional public-service crisis. During the first ten rounds, each point remaining in the fund creates 1.50 group points under group approval and 2.50 under direct implementation. After the first block, each matching pool is randomly assigned to one update:

- **Conditions improve:** the fictional budget passes, waiting times fall, planning resumes, and the group-approval rate rises to 2.50.
- **Conditions remain strained:** the crisis description and the 1.50 group-approval rate continue.

The direct-implementation rate remains 2.50 and all decision rules remain the same in both updates.

Payment

You receive a fixed EUR 10 participation payment plus a performance bonus of up to EUR 5. After the task, the computer selects one round from each ten-round block. The points earned in those two rounds determine the bonus: more selected-round points produce a larger payment. Your total payment is therefore at most EUR 15. If you stop early, the fixed participation payment and any performance payment are handled under the laboratory's payment procedure. PCRC administers information required for payment and statutory reporting separately from experimental responses and deletes the identity-to-code link when payment is complete.

Possible benefits, inconvenience, and risks

There is no direct personal benefit beyond payment. The study may contribute to research on group decision making and institutions. Foreseeable risks are minimal. The fictional crisis, waiting for other group members, or decisions involving unequal allocations may cause mild discomfort. There is no deception about the decision rules or payment calculation. You may ask the laboratory manager for procedural help at any time.

Privacy, storage, and reporting

The experimental interface uses a participant code rather than your name. It records decisions, group and pool identifiers, assigned update, response times, expectations, questionnaire answers, and payoffs on University of Turku IT servers in Finland. PCRC retains identifying recruitment and payment information and gives researchers only coded data. Access to coded research data is limited to Janne Tukiainen, Hector Bahamonde, and authorised personnel. The data may also be retained for compatible future scientific research. Publications and presentations will not identify individual participants. Details, legal bases, retention, and your data-protection rights appear in the accompanying privacy notice.

Questions

For questions about the study, contact the Principal Investigator, Janne Tukiainen, Professor at the Turku School of Economics, University of Turku: janne.tukiainen@utu.fi; +358 50 308 3620. For data-protection questions, the University of Turku Data Protection Officer can be reached at dpo@utu.fi or +358 29 450 3009.

Attachment 5 – screen guide

Examples of the Experimental Interface

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The images below are examples. Values and wording shown on a particular screen depend on the current round and the update assigned to the participant's matching pool.

Block 1 — Round 1 of 10

You have 20 points. Points in the **public-services fund** create group points that are shared equally among all five members. Points you do not put in the fund remain yours.

Should the selected person's proposal require approval? Click anywhere on one row.

Method	What happens to the proposal?	Fund rate	If citizens reject
G Group approval required	The other four citizens see the full proposal; at least three must approve	Each point left in the fund creates 1.50 group points	Everyone chooses their own fund allocation at the same rate
D Decision takes effect directly	The proposal is implemented without an approval vote by the other citizens	Each point left in the fund creates 2.50 group points	No rejection stage

Figure 1: Method ballot. Participants compare the approval rule, fund rate, and consequence of rejection, then select a row. The leader is chosen only after this ballot.

You are the selected person for this round

Propose how many points every citizen should put in the public-services fund and whether up to 20 fund points should move to your payoff. Your proposal takes effect directly, and the remaining fund uses the 2.50 rate.

How many points should every citizen put in the public-services fund?

How many fund points should move to your own payoff?

Next

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Figure 2: Leader proposal. The selected participant proposes the common fund allocation and any transfer to their own payoff. The screen states whether approval is required and shows the applicable fund rate.

Approve or reject the proposal

The selected person proposes that every citizen put 10 points in the fund and that 5 fund points move to their own payoff. At least three of the four other citizens must approve. If the proposal is rejected, every citizen will choose their own fund allocation.

Do you approve or reject the selected person's proposal?

- ☐ Approve the proposal
☐ Reject the proposal

Next

Figure 3: Approval decision. When group approval is required, each of the four nonleaders sees the complete proposal and chooses approve or reject. At least three approvals are required.

Block 1 — Round 2 result

Group choice: Group approval required

Method ballots: Group approval required: 3; Decision takes effect directly: 2.

Selected person's proposed allocation for each citizen	10
Proposed transfer to the selected person's payoff	5
Approval votes among the four other citizens	3 of 4
Approval result	Approved
Total points placed in the public-services fund	50
Fund points moved to the selected person's payoff	5
Points left in the public-services fund	45
Group points received by every member	13.50
Your payoff if this round is selected	23.50

Only group totals are shown. Participants are reshuffled anonymously before the next round.

Next

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Figure 4: Round feedback. Participants see the chosen method, aggregate ballots, proposal and approval outcome, fund totals, group return, and their own potential payoff. No participant identity is displayed.